Himaayah Schools
TEENAGERS BUILDING CIRCLE

GUIDE

وَكَانَ بَيْنَ ذَٰلِكَ قَوَامًا

"And they hold a just balance between the two." (al-Furqān 25:67)

Money Smart Muslim Teens

Earn ḥalāl, spend wisely, save with a purpose, give generously, and stay away from ribā, debt and betting.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Money is a trust from Allah. On the Day of Resurrection, a person will not move until he is asked about his wealth: “where he earned it and how he spent it” (at-Tirmidhī, 2417). The habits you build with small amounts of money as a teenager, pocket money, gifts, the profit from a small business, will follow you into adult life.

This guide shows Muslim teenagers how to think about money the way Islām teaches: earn it in a ḥalāl way, spend it wisely without waste or stinginess, save for what matters, give generously, stay away from ribā and debt, and start earning in small, honest ways. It ends with a budget you can use this month and a 4-week challenge.

> وَالَّذِينَ إِذَا أَنفَقُوا لَمْ يُسْرِفُوا وَلَمْ يَقْتُرُوا وَكَانَ بَيْنَ ذَٰلِكَ قَوَامًا
>
> **“And those who, when they spend, are neither wasteful nor stingy, but hold a just balance between the two.”**
>
> Al-Furqān 25:67, describing the servants of the Most Merciful.

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Part 1 Money in Islām

- **Wealth belongs to Allah**; we are trustees of it: "Spend out of that in which He has made you successors" (al-Ḥadīd 57:7).
- **It is a test**: "Your wealth and your children are but a trial" (at-Taghābun 64:15).
- **It can be a means to Paradise**: "How good is righteous wealth for a righteous man" (Aḥmad, 17763).
- **Richness is in the heart**: "Wealth is not having many possessions; real wealth is the richness of the soul" (al-Bukhārī 6446, Muslim 1051).

Part 2 Earn it ḥalāl

"Allah is pure and accepts only what is pure" (Muslim, 1015). The Prophet ﷺ said: "No one has ever eaten better food than what he earns with his own hands" (al-Bukhārī, 2072). Honest work is honourable, whatever it is.

Ḥalāl ways to earn	Ḥarām ways to avoid
Honest work and services	Theft, fraud and cheating customers
Trade with honesty about the goods	Hiding faults in what you sell (Muslim, 102)
Making and selling things	Selling ḥarām things (alcohol, drugs, indecent content)
Skills: tutoring, design, repairs	Ribā, gambling and betting
Gifts given freely	Bribes and "settlement"

Part 3 Spend it wisely

Before you buy, ask: **Is it a need or a want?** Needs come first: food, transport, school things. Wants are fine in moderation, after needs and saving. And beware of spending to impress others: "Eat, drink, give charity and dress, without waste or pride" (an-Nasāʾī, 2559).

Smart spending habits	
Wait 24 hours	For anything that is not a need, wait a day. Most impulse wants disappear.
Compare prices	Check more than one seller; ask about quality.
Track every naira	Write down what you spend for a month. You will be surprised.
Do not copy your friends' spending	Their money, their choices, their debts.
Beware of data and airtime drains	Subscriptions, games and constant top-ups add up.
Avoid waste	"Do not waste; indeed, the wasteful are brothers of the devils" (al-Isrāʾ 17:26–27).

Part 4 Save with a purpose

Pay yourself first: when money comes in, put a fixed part aside for saving before you spend anything. Many people use a simple rule: save at least **20%** of every amount you receive. Save for something specific: a laptop, a course, a business, your sister's school fees.

- Keep savings separate from spending money: a different box, account or wallet.
- Set a goal, a date and a weekly amount: "₦30,000 for a phone by June: ₦1,500 a week".
- Keep savings ḥalāl: a savings account without interest, or ask your parents about Islamic (non-interest) banking.
- Celebrate reaching a goal, then set the next one.

Part 5 Give generously

Charity is not only for the rich. “Protect yourselves from the Fire, even with half a date” (al-Bukhārī 1417, Muslim 1016). “Charity does not decrease wealth” (Muslim, 2588). Give a small fixed part, for example 5% or 10% of what you receive, to a relative in need, a neighbour, a masjid project or an orphan. And when you have savings above the niṣāb for a year, learn about zakāh (see our guide **The Fiqh of Zakāh**).

Part 6 Avoid ribā, debt and gambling

> وَأَحَلَّ اللَّهُ الْبَيْعَ وَحَرَّمَ الرِّبَا
>
> **“And Allah has permitted trade and forbidden ribā (interest).”**
>
> Al-Baqarah 2:275.

Danger	Why to avoid it
Ribā (interest)	One of the major sins. The Prophet ﷺ cursed the one who takes it, the one who gives it, the one who writes it and the witnesses (Muslim, 1598).
Betting and gambling (sports betting, online casinos)	Forbidden in Islām (al-Mā’idah 5:90). Betting apps are designed so that most players lose. Many young people have lost school fees and savings to them.
“Double your money” and Ponzi schemes	If it promises fast, guaranteed returns without real work or trade, it is almost certainly a scam. Early “winners” are paid with later people’s money.
Borrowing for wants	The Prophet ﷺ sought refuge from debt (al-Bukhārī, 832). Borrow only for real needs, write it down, and repay on time.
Loan apps	Some charge huge interest and harass borrowers. Never borrow from them.

Part 7 Start earning small

Earning even a little teaches more than any lesson. Always agree with your parents first, keep your studies and prayers first, and be honest in every deal.

Idea	What you need
Tutoring younger pupils	A subject you are good at; patience
Making snacks, drinks or crafts to sell	A small budget, hygiene and a parent’s help
Phone and computer help for neighbours	Digital skills (see our guide **Digital Skills for Beginners**)
Graphic design for small businesses	A phone or laptop and Canva (see our guide **Design with Canva**)
Washing cars, running errands, gardening	Reliability and good manners
Reselling goods you understand	Honesty about quality; careful records

Plan My budget and the 4-week challenge

Fill this in for one month. Every naira should have a job.

Money in this month	₦
Pocket money	
Gifts	
Earnings	
Total in	

Money out	Plan (₦)	Actual (₦)
Saving (pay yourself first)		
Charity		
Transport and school needs		
Data and airtime		
Food and snacks		
Wants and fun		
Total out		

Week	Challenge	Done
1	Write down everything you spend, every day.	☐
2	Save 20% of everything you receive, and wait 24 hours before any want.	☐
3	Give charity at least once, and cancel one thing that drains your money.	☐
4	Earn something honestly, however small, and add it to your savings.	☐

Parents A word to parents

- Give a fixed allowance and let your child manage it; small mistakes now prevent big ones later.
- Talk openly about money: how you budget, save and give.
- Warn clearly about betting apps and loan apps, and check your child's phone for them.
- Encourage small, supervised ways of earning, and praise honesty over profit.

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. **On the Day of Resurrection, we will be asked about our wealth:**

   a) How much we had b) Where we earned it and how we spent it c) Who gave it d) Nothing

2. **“Pay yourself first” means:**

   a) Spend first, save what is left b) Save a fixed part before spending c) Borrow first d) Buy what you want first

3. **Sports betting in Islām is:**

   a) Allowed if small b) Allowed on weekends c) Forbidden d) A kind of trade

4. **An investment promising to double your money in a week with no real work is most likely:**

   a) A scam b) A ḥalāl trade c) A bank d) Zakāh

5. **Which verse describes spending “neither wastefully nor stingily”?**

   a) Al-Furqān 25:67 b) Al-Baqarah 2:255 c) Al-Ikhlāṣ 112:1 d) An-Nās 114:1

6. **Charity, according to the Prophet ﷺ:**

   a) Decreases wealth b) Is only for the rich c) Must be large d) Does not decrease wealth

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	b) Where earned and how spent	4	a) A scam
2	b) Save a fixed part first	5	a) Al-Furqān 25:67
3	c) Forbidden	6	d) Does not decrease wealth

Join the Teenagers Building Circle

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وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

“And my success is only through Allah.” (Hūd 11:88)

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Small money, big habits.

This guide from the Himaayah Teenagers Building Circle helps teens manage their money the way Islām teaches, and start earning in small, honest ways.

- Money as a trust and a test
- Needs, wants and smart spending
- Saving: pay yourself first
- Ribā, betting apps, loan apps and “double your money” scams
- A monthly budget and a 4-week challenge

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